

Title

Feasibility and design of a mandala-based creative expression intervention for psychological resilience in palliative care family members

Abstract

Family members caring for patients with life-limiting illnesses experience substantial psychological distress, anxiety, and demoralized mood. Structured creative activities may offer accessible, low-cost approaches to enhance coping and emotional resilience. This protocol describes a randomized controlled trial evaluating mandala-based artistic engagement for family caregivers in palliative care settings. A total of 84 family members will be randomly assigned 1:1 to either a 4-week mandala artistic engagement program or standard care control. Intervention participants will complete one structured 1-hour mandala drawing and coloring session weekly in a calm, dedicated space using provided materials. Primary outcome measures include the Psychological Well-Being Scale administered at baseline and 4 weeks. Secondary assessments encompass the Spiritual Well-Being Scale and quality-of-life measures. We hypothesize that creative engagement will enhance psychological well-being through mechanisms of mindful attention, self-expression, and symbolic personal meaning-making during a period of existential challenge.